

The unique part of this micro aid scheme is that lenders and borrowers can connect with each other. Many lenders were so impressed by the entrepreneur that they expressed wishes to pump in more money into the businesses. A case in point is New York Times correspondent Nicholas Kristof who met his business partners when he visited Kabul and saw for himself how his loans were helping people desperately needing cash.

Established two years ago by Matthew and Jessica Flannery, an American couple working as volunteers in Kenya, Tanzania and Uganda, Kiva has raised \$7 million in two years from more than 70,000 individuals and extended microfinance to about 9,000 businesses. It has also fostered numerous personal relationships between people from varied socio economic backgrounds—a very good example of combining philanthropy and networking.

9.5 Barbie Girls

(<http://www.stardoll.com/>)

A large number of sites on the Net are unsafe for children. Not this one. In fact this site is developed for kids and teens, especially for girls with a yen for dressing up her dolls. Which every little girl seem to have. In fact most of the members on this site are from 7 to 17 years old.

Anyone older than 12 can become a member. For kids under 12, parental consent is required. Once you get yourself registered you get 25 Stardollars to buy clothes and accessories for your signature MeDoll. Your imagination is the only limit here as you can choose from hundreds of hairstyles, skin tones, nose shapes etc. Dress up the MeDoll in clothes of your choice using those Stardollars. Once your initial account is exhausted you can pay for more purchase using credit cards. Each member can have 10 celeb dolls on their profile page. These celeb dolls range from actors to singers to athletes to royals. Some are also offered free of cost.